HOW TO TALK TO ANYONE

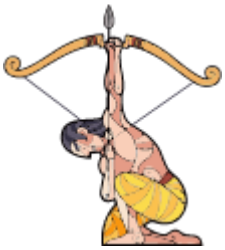
Learn The Secrets of Good Communication And The Little Tricks for Big Success in Relationships



ADAM BROWN

How to Talk to Anyone

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Introduction

Have you ever found yourself in a crowded room with no one to talk to? Do you often keep to yourself at parties or events, because you lack the confidence to strike a conversation with someone? Are you constantly feeling anxious about meeting new people because you don't know what to say?

If you answered yes to any of these questions, then it's time that you learn the secret to communicating better.

Let's face it. Knowing how to express yourself in different social settings is one of the most important skills you need to develop. Without the basic skill of connecting with people through conversation, it will be hard for you live a normal life. your social life will be nonexistent, your career will suffer, and you can pretty much kiss dating goodbye.

It may seem daunting to you right now, but learning how to talk to anyone is actually quite simple. This book will teach you everything you need to know about starting and maintaining conversations with anyone. You'll learn how to: Make all your conversations matter Master the skill of listening

Engage in meaningful small talk Avoid common conversation faux pas ….. and many more!

Once you become a master at talking to anyone, it will be much easier for you to succeed in life. Aside from becoming more confident, you'll know how to make the right impression wherever you go.

Thank you for downloading this book! I wish you the best of luck!

Chapter 1: Reviving the Dying Art of Conversation

Have you ever found yourself in a roomful of people, with no one to talk to?

Digital technology and social media may have made it much easier to reconnect with old friends and family members, but what has it done to everyday conversation?

We live in hyper-connected world where most of our communication is now done through email and chats, and not so much in person anymore. We've become too reliant on technology that we're starting to lose touch of the real art of verbal (face to face) communication.

While it's true that not all people have the gift of gab, that's no excuse to not master the art of conversation. Having real time face to face communication is not only a crucial element in a thriving community, it's also the pillar of any healthy relationship. Through verbal conversation, we become more honest, open, and willing to foster a connection with other people.

Do you still remember what it was like 20, 30 years ago when we didn't have the internet to talk to each other and our daily lives revolved around conversations and people? Whether it was with the postman making his rounds, or the neighbor tending to his lawn, it seemed like there was always something to talk

about. And it didn't matter if you talked about the news, the weather, or even the latest neighborhood gossip, there was always this sense of connection and belongingness that came from those small conversations.

> Conversations are, and have always been, good for the soul.

Conversations help bridge the gap between people. It knits a community together and makes it stronger. It becomes the way to better understanding something or someone. When you ask questions or give answers, you learn new information that you can use to make your life better. It also allows you to relive someone else's experience and feel his or her emotions, like when you hear a story from their past or listen to their plans for the future. Most importantly, conversations give you the unique opportunity to see things through different perspectives. Without conversation, there would be no interaction.

I'm not saying that digital interaction accounts for nothing. In fact, it's made the world much smaller. But let's face it. It still doesn't compare to having a face-to-face conversation with someone. Sure, you may text, email, chat, all you want, but you'll find that the bond just isn't the same. It will always feel like something's lacking when you don't converse in person.

Just like any art, conversation requires practice and dedication. Contrary to popular belief, the best conversationalists are not always the smoothest or smartest talkers, it's actually the best listeners. Because at the end of the day, good conversations are

not monologues or personal speeches, they're a two-way exchange of ideas that ultimately turns into respect.

If engaging in deep and meaningful conversations have become a dying art, how then do we save it? Here are 10 simple things that you can intentionally do to make your conversations mean something.

Stop multi-tasking. Admit it. Most of the time, our minds are half in a conversation and half somewhere else. Don't let multi-tasking taking away the joy of being in the moment with someone you're sharing a conversation with.

Ask the right questions. Get the other person to share with you their thoughts by asking open ended questions. Start your questions with the 5Ws (what, who, where, when, why) and be amazed with what you can learn from the other person.

Focus on the other person. Conversations are not the avenue for you to talk about yourself non-stop so try not to treat it as your very own personal talk show. Instead, take time to focus on the person you're talking to and what he or she has to say.

Respect the other person's experiences. It's very rare that you'll have the same exact experiences as the other person. It might be similar in some aspects, but even then, that should not be an excuse for you to hijack the conversation. No matter how tempting it is, give them the space to tell their personal story, how they want to tell it.

Avoid advocating for your in the beginning of the conversation at least. Don't see this as your chance to talk about something that you're interested in, but the other person clearly isn't. Try

to find your middle ground if you want to keep the conversation going.

Make your point once and leave it at Sometimes, it just feels natural to make the same point over and over again. But repeating yourself doesn't mean that you're passionate about something, it shows that you're not really present in the conversation. Saying it once is usually enough to prove your point.

Be honest. There's nothing worse than being in the middle of a conversation and being found out that you've been faking it all along. Just be real. If you don't know, then just say that you don't. Always err on the side of caution.

Allow the conversation to flow While it helps to know specific conversation guidelines, you don't have to stick to a set template when having a conversation with someone. Let the thoughts flow so that the conversation moves organically. The best conversations are those that come from the heart, rather than from a script.

Be Always remember that it takes two or more people to engage in a conversation. So it's important that you find the perfect balance between talking and listening. Don't take up all the airtime. If you have something to say, make sure to be brief, so that you can give others the chance to speak.

Last but not the least, It's common for most of us to get so engrossed with their own thoughts and ideas that they completely forget to listen to what the other person is saying. We often listen just so we know what to reply, and not really to understand where the other person is coming from. Try to

listen more and see how it improves the quality of your conversations with other people.

If there's one thing you should remember about reviving the dying art of conversations, it's this: be truly present and interested in the conversation. You'll never know what kind of connection you'll be creating when you allow yourself to get caught up in a good meaningful conversation.

Chapter 2: Mastering the Skill of Listening

Let's be real for just one second. Do you make an effort to listen to really listen to people? While most people think that listening doesn't require much effort, the sad truth is, it's also those same people who make terrible listeners. Why? Because listening is not something that is consciously taught in school. Often times, it's taught as a passive skill that should come naturally to you. If you can hear something, then it's expected to know how to listen.

But any communication expert will tell you that hearing is not exactly the same as listening. Hearing is the act of picking up sound by the ear, while listening is the process of hearing a sound and making sense of what you heard. Listening is a skill that involves conscious effort and if used properly, can help you communicate better. Most of us have this misconception that the best talkers are those with the right words. But the truth is, the best conversationalists are actually those who have mastered the skill of listening.

If you want to improve the way you communicate with anyone, then you need to learn how to really listen to people. Instead of rushing to create a connection with the person you're talking to, you need to pause and start paying attention to what the other person is saying. Most people want to show that they understand what the other person is saying immediately, without really taking time to listen. While it may look and feel like the message is coming across, people usually don't have a

clue what's going on and they're just jumping into conclusions to get through a conversation. .

To really listen to someone, you need to slow down and let the person get their full message across before you respond. The problem with most people is that they mistake listening for planning what they're going to say as a response. It's not really listening if you're not being mindful of what the other person is saying.

But how exactly does learning how to listen make you a better conversationalist? Well, for one, listening helps you engage better with people. When you listen, you have the chance to pick up verbal and non-verbal clues that will help you respond better. You won't just know the right words to say, but you'll also know the right way to say it. Instead of glazing over and waiting for your turn to speak, you'll actually learn something from what the other person is saying.

Want to know how you can be a better listener in your everyday conversations? Then here are some tips to help you practice your listening skills.

> Don't make assumptions about what the other person is thinking

Making assumptions clouds your better judgement. You're already training your brain to only accept information that matches your assumption so you're not getting the real gist of what the person you're talking to is trying to say. When you

assume what the other person is thinking, it's like closing your mind to accepting new information. This then leads to misinterpretation and makes active listening almost impossible.

Be in the moment

Instead of waiting for you turn to speak up, try to focus on every word that the other person is saying. Often times when you're nervous, you may think you're listening, but the truth is you're too focused on your own thoughts. This habit may be hard to shake off, but learning how to clear your thoughts and be in the moment will not only make you a better listener, it will also make you a better human being.

Try to understand what was said

And as you listen, make sure to understand what the other person is saying without adding your own bias to the message. Just take it as it is. Most of us have a tendency to think ahead to what the other person will say next, but these predictions often prove to be inaccurate. So, instead of predicting how the conversation will flow, just relax and give the other person the chance to speak up.

Stop yourself from adding input

If there's one thing that you should remember about being a better listener, it's this. You don't have to give you input to everything. Be polite and only give your opinion or insight when directly asked. When you're actively listening, the only thing that you should think of is whether you should ask a follow-up question.

Think before you respond

Once the other person has finished speaking, a good listener will usually take some time to think before giving a response. All it takes is a few seconds to come up something meaningful. Don't just respond for the sake of having something to say, but take a few seconds to really think about what the other person said. This way, you'll avoid giving careless remarks that could hurt your own reputation.

Listening is actually more difficult than speaking up, but it's a valuable skill that will help you become a better communicator. The simplest way to improve your listening is to get into the habit of clarifying what you heard. This will force you to listen carefully and attentively to whatever is said to you.

Because you need to listen carefully to be able to repeat what was said, you'll be motivated to pay close attention to what the other person is saying. Instead of allowing your mind to

wander, you'll make more effort to listen to every single detail in order to accurately summarize what you heard. Repeating back what you heard to the person you're talking to gives him or her the chance to reword the message if they realize that you didn't get it the first time.This makes people feel like they're being heard and acknowledged so when you do give your response, they're more likely to trust it.

Next time you find yourself in a situation where you need to talk to someone, here's a valuable piece of advice: just listen. If at the end of your conversations you realize that you didn't really learn anything, that's a sign that you weren't really listening. True dialogue will only happen once you stop pretending to listen.

Chapter 3: Making Small Talk

Even if you don't consider yourself a master at conversations, starting a conversation with someone you know is not that difficult. All you have to do is pick up where you left off and it should be smooth sailing from there. But it's a bit different with people you've just met. There's no history to fall back on, and it can be nerve wracking to approach someone and try to build rapport with a casual conversation.

Whether you like it or not, talking to strangers is a crucial skill that you need to have if you want to succeed in life. This skill won't just serve you well in your business and career, it will also help you become a better human being. If you're going to think about it, small talk is where all relationships begin. Without it, you might as well expect a long miserable life alone.

So what's the secret to making small talk with just about anyone in any situation? This question requires a 2-part answer. First, you ask questions, and second, have an exit strategy. Your goal is to get the other person talking so that you have enough clues to work with to keep the conversation going and once the conversation is through, have a non-awkward way to exit the conversation gracefully.

Let's start with the questions. Of course, you don't just ask any question. You ask the right ones to engage the person you've just met. Turn it into a game and always ask a relevant follow-up question once they've given their answer. Try to milk one

topic as much as you can before moving on to the next. This way, it doesn't seem like your interviewing or interrogating them.

Let's assume that you know nothing about the person that you're going to be talking to. To kick off the conversation, you need to find something that's common to the both of you. Your safest bet would be the environment that you're both in at that specific moment. Take a look around to see if there's anything that is worth talking about. Is it a piece of art, a background song, or the interior design or the architecture of the place? Once you find something that's interesting, think of questions that you can ask to break the ice.

Once you find yourself in a promising conversation, you can then start asking your next level questions. Depending on the occasion, and the person you're talking to, ask questions that will draw them to talk about themselves. Some questions that work well in parties and social gatherings are:

- Where are you from? What brings you here?
- How's your week been so far?
- Would you recommend the (name of drink or food that's being served in the event)?
- How do you know (common person)?
- What do you usually do on weekends?
- Anything awesome that's happening in your life right now? Would you care to share?
- What cool things should i do if i'm ever in (the other person's city/neighborhood)?

- Do you have any food recommendations that I should try in (the other person's city/neighborhood)?
- What's the last good movie you saw in theatres?
- How did you get into (the other person's industry)? Would you still choose the job you have right now if you could go back in time?

There are plenty of questions that you can ask so limit yourself to this list. Just remember to steer clear of questions that could come off as offensive. Always use your better and sound judgement before asking questions so that you don't get into trouble.

Now let's talk about the right way to exit a conversation. Ending a conversation is just as important as starting one because you want to leave the person you're talking to with a good impression of yourself. There's nothing more horrifying than having to walk away from someone you just met on awkward terms. If you find that a conversation is simply finished or already stalling, here are some ways to wrap it up politely.

- Well, it's been great! Thanks for telling me about (topic you talked about). Would you like to exchange contact info?
- I'm going to grab some (food or drink). It was great to meet you.
- It was nice to meet you. Enjoy the rest of the (party, event, conference, meeting).
- Glad we got to connect over (topic you talked about). I'm going to (say hello to someone, check out the venue, go grab some snacks)

- Excuse me, I need to use the restroom. Hope to catch up with you again later.

When making small talk, it really doesn't matter what you think about your conversational skills. With the right strategies, small talk is a skill that you'll be able to easily master. Here are a few guidelines on how you can get better at small talk.

> Seek out opportunities to make small talk

Here's what you need to know about small talk; the more times you do it, the more comfortable you'll become with it. So take every chance you get to practice. It doesn't have to be at an event or a party. You can practice with the barista at your favorite coffee shop or the people you come across as you do your weekly shopping. Being intentional in seeking out opportunities for small talk will help you think quick on your feet and even give you the necessary skills to gauge a person based on his or her body language and voice tone. But be careful when choosing strangers to practice on because the last thing you want is to force anyone who clearly isn't interested to engage in a conversation with you.

> Have a goal to make small talk meaningful.

Even if you don't think you're ever going to see the other person ever again, setting your own personal goal will motivate you to step out of your comfort zone. Whether it's committing to meet at least 3 new people at a party, or exchanging cards with a couple of executives at a conference, having a goal also gives you a way to measure your progress within a given time frame. So for example, if you're preparing for a big sales conference that's happening in a couple of months, a practical goal that you could set is to talk to at least 2 new people every week. This should give you enough time to practice your small talk techniques so that when the big day comes, you won't feel so nervous. Think of it as if you were rehearsing for a big performance.

Get friendly

Approaching a stranger can be quite intimidating, especially if you're not exactly the type who likes to start conversations with anyone. Here's a trick that many master conversationalists swear by. Instead of seeing that other person as a stranger, imagine he or she was a friend that you know really well. Shifting your perspective is an effective way to lessen the anxiety that comes with meeting someone for the first time. Pretending that you're speaking to a friend also makes your voice come off warmer and friendlier, so that's an added perk for the person that you'll be talking to. But of course, try not to get too friendly because some people might find it

Cut yourself some slack

When all else fails, don't be too hard on yourself. There's no point being too critical on yourself when you're faced with long silences and awkward moments. Sure, it may be embarrassing at first, but once you get the hang of it, making mistakes like forgetting someone's name or failing at your jokes, won't seem that big of a deal anymore. Plus, it's very unlikely that the other person will still remember the minor faux pas once the event or party is over.

They say that the best conversationalists are those who show genuine interest in other people. So getting other people to share their personal stories can be a far more rewarding experience than to entertain them with your own. People you meet will always know more than you do so take advantage of that.

Chapter 4: Conversation Dos and Don’ts

While it’s true that there are people who are better at conversations than others, the ability to talk to anyone is mostly a skill that can be learned, rather than a talent that you’re born with. Just because you don’t consider yourself a good conversationalist at this point, doesn’t mean that there’s no hope for you to become better at it in the future. It’s just a matter of having a goal that you want to reach. Whether you’re trying to improve your conversation skills to get a long awaited promotion, or to meet new people and expand your social circle, there are certain reminders that you need to keep in mind. Remember these basic conversation dos and don’ts to become a better conversationalist in no time.

Do...

Initiate the conversation

If you’re first instinct is to shy away in social settings, then it’s time to get out there to make the first move. You’re not going to be a good conversationalist keeping your head low and if you really want to be someone who can get the room’s attention, then you need to have the courage to initiate the conversation. You don’t even have to be flashy about it. Just approach

someone and make small talk about the weather, pets, or whatever you think is appropriate at that time. Try not to overthink the conversation. Just have fun, learn something, and who knows? You might just meet some very interesting people along the way. Be polite and give compliments

Once you get a conversation going, make it your #1 rule to be polite. Be pleasant and avoid talking about sensitive topics like race, religion, politics, especially if you're dealing with a conservative crowd. If you want to make a good impression, be generous with your compliments. Show that you notice someone by giving a sincere and genuine compliment. Pick out a detail or feature about the person that you really like and tell him or her about it. This is a subtle, yet effective way to connect with a person without coming off like you're trying too hard.

Smile

Smiling will not only make you look more attractive, it will also make you seem more approachable. People will naturally gravitate towards people who smile more because it makes them feel at ease. When you need to ask for directions for example, you're more likely to approach someone who is smiling than someone who isn't. Why? Because smiling can make someone appear helpful and kind.Smiling can also take away the awkwardness of meeting someone for the first time so before you say anything, make sure to show off those pearly whites. It will help you make a good first impression.

Maintain eye contact

Eye contact is important because it reflects sincerity when talking with another person. You know when a conversation is going well when you can maintain eye contact with the person you're talking to. If you're always looking away while you're conversing with someone, the other person might think you're hiding something. It could also give away the impression that you're lying or insincere. Practice keeping eye contact with everyone you talk to. If you feel uncomfortable about looking into someone's eyes, a good trick is to look at their eyebrows or the bridge of their nose.

Watch for body language

Actions always speak louder than words, so when talking to someone, make sure to always pay attention to their body language so that you know if it's time to move on. If you continue to talk about something that the other person is clearly not interested in, you might find yourself alone without warning, or worse, avoided at all cost. Watch out for cues like crossed arms or lack of eye contact to know if the person you're talking to is not engaged in the conversation. If you sense any uncomfortable body language, consider changing the topic or making a graceful exit.

Let's now move on to the don'ts.

> Don't....

Interrupt the other person

There are 2 ways to interrupt a person. The first is when a person interrupts the speaker mid-sentence, and the second is when a person tries to divert attention away from the topic with the phrases “by the way” or “which reminds me”. Either way, interrupting is not appreciated in any social setting. Even if you badly want to contribute to the discussion, make sure to do it without interrupting anyone. Let others finish what they have to say before you speak up. This actually gives you the upper hand because all you have to do is listen.

Be a conversational narcissist

Conversational narcissists are people who just can’t stop talking about themselves. They not only make lousy friends, but they can also be very annoying people to talk to. If you think you have the tendency to be one, try to restrain yourself. Don’t one-up another person for the sake of having something to say. Remember, your goal in conversation is not to show your superiority over others. The more you talk about yourself, the more you’re showing off your insecurity. Instead of always putting yourself in the limelight, focus the limelight on other people. Your conversations are not one-man acts.

Overshare information

Another thing you need to avoid is oversharing information. Try not to be that person who pours out your entire life story to a stranger on your first meet. This signals a level of desperation that throws people off. You want to still have an air of mystery about you when people meet you for the first time so make sure to share only necessary information. At the same time, you

should also avoid prying too much into people's lives. If the person you're talking to doesn't want to share something, respect their privacy. Wait for them to get comfortable before asking sensitive questions. And even then, if they really don't want to talk about it, don't make a big deal out of it. Just change the subject.

Come to an event unprepared

Always make sure to stay up to date with current events and important issues. This way, you'll be able to comment and give your opinions on issues that matter the most to people. Read up on popular fiction, watch the latest movies, and keep up with recent news. When confronted with serious topics, be prepared to question popular opinion. This will keep the conversation unbiased and open to different opinions. Just be careful not to offend anyone by being belligerent. Make your points clearly and if possible, with humor. Witty comments that are clever and spontaneous are always welcome in any conversation.

Talk to just one person when you're in a group

If you're part of a group conversation, don't focus your attention to just one person. Try to engage with everyone there so that no one feels dangling or left behind. Don't dwell too much on inside jokes or remember when stories with someone you know in the group if you're talking to a lot of people you're meeting for the first time. Think of topics that you feel everyone can chime in so that you don't leave any space for awkward silence. Keep the personal stories for another time.

Understanding the basic rules of conversation prevents you from committing conversation faux pas, which will help you become a better conversationalist. Just try to act natural and don't be afraid to be yourself. People will appreciate your company more if they sense your sincerity in your efforts.

Final Words

So there you have it. The ability to talk to anyone is a skill that you can master with just a few tips. Don't let your lack of communication skills stop you from developing relationships with people. Now, you don't have to cringe at the thought of making small talk or initiating a conversation with someone.
By learning the valuable art of conversation, you won't just learn new things, but you'll also understand yourself and others better. I hope this book gives you that boost of confidence you need to reach your professional and personal goals.



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